DINNER · POPPY'S KITCHEN



Pepperoni Pizza Pasta Bake

Everything good about pizza, baked into a bubbly pan of Rao's fusilli.

4, plus a lunch	45 min
SERVES	START TO TABLE
15 min	**30 min**
PREP	COOK

Easy weeknight

🛒 What you need

FROM THE STORE

- ▢ **1 lb** Rao's fusilli
- ▢ **1 jar (24 oz)** Rao's marinara
- ▢ **2½ cups** Tillamook mozzarella, shredded
- ▢ **1 tray** Creminelli pepperoni
- ▢ **½ cup** Grated parmesan

FROM THE PANTRY

- ▢ **1 tsp** Dried oregano
- ▢ **½ tsp** Garlic powder
- ▢ Salt for the pasta water, olive oil

⚡ **First:** Water on to boil and oven to 400°F.

GEAR

Big pot · Colander · 9×13 baking dish

🔥 Let's cook

1. Oven to 400°F. Boil a big pot of well-salted water.
2. Cook the fusilli 2 minutes less than the box says (it finishes in the oven). Save ½ cup pasta water, then drain. ⏱️ 9 min
3. Back in the pot, stir the pasta with the marinara, the pasta water, oregano, garlic powder, half the parmesan and 1 cup mozzarella. 🧒 Kids can do this
4. Pour into a 9×13 dish. Top with the rest of the mozzarella. 🧒 Kids can do this
5. Lay the pepperoni over the top and finish with parmesan. 🧒 Kids can do this
6. Bake until bubbling and the pepperoni curls and crisps. ⏱️ 18–20 min
7. Rest 5 minutes before scooping.



CHEF'S SECRET

Underboil the pasta by 2 minutes and add a splash of pasta water. The noodles soak up sauce in the oven instead of turning mushy and dry.

Poppy's draft. Change something? Tell Poppy with 💡 so the card learns.



DINNER · FLIP SIDE

Pepperoni Pizza Pasta Bake

👩‍🍳 Kitchen crew: kid jobs

- [ ] Stir the sauce and cheese into the pasta
- [ ] Spread the cheese over the top
- [ ] Make a pepperoni pattern on top
- [ ] Set a timer for the pasta and the bake

Knives, the stove and the oven: a grown-up stays right there. Steps marked 🧒 **Kids can do this** on the front are theirs to own.

⏰ MAKE IT AHEAD

Assemble up to a day ahead, cover and refrigerate. Bake 30 minutes covered, 10 uncovered.

🥡 LEFTOVERS

Reheats beautifully: microwave with a splash of water, or 15 minutes at 350°F.

🔁 SWAP IT

- Any short pasta (i190)
- Add sliced mini sweet peppers or mushrooms

🍽️ SERVE IT WITH

Garlic toast and a spring-mix salad

📝 How'd it go tonight?

😍 Love it 🙂 Like it 😐 It's OK 👎 Not for me

Date _____ Cooked by _____

Helpers _____ Next time _____

Notes and tweaks (snap a photo and send it to Poppy with 💡)

Poppy's draft. Change something? Tell Poppy with 💡 so the card learns.